

Audit Retention Module

OOF™ Origin Open Foundation™

Independent Methodological Authority

Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™

Architecture Family: ADIT® — Continuous Audit & Evidence Governance Architecture

Parent Standard: Audit Preservation Standard

Operational Layer: Audit Preservation Governance Layer

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Audit & Evidence Governance

Type: Parent Standard Module

Governed Space: Audit Retention

Version: 1.0

Status: Canonical · Open Module

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Compatibility: OOF Methodology OS · GOA™ · OBIDENITY® · INTEGROS® · ORA™ · AGA™ · AIG® · CLIA® · MGIA™ · ASGA™ · RIS™

AI-Readable: Yes

Authority: OOF®

Protection: MIP™ — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Governed Space

Audit Retention

Canonical Definition

Audit Retention Module defines the governance framework for determining how long audit evidence, records, findings, responses, approvals, and supporting documentation must be retained throughout their lifecycle. It establishes retention methodology, retention schedules, governance controls, lifecycle requirements, and continuous retention assurance necessary to ensure that audit information remains available for governance, regulatory, legal, operational, and historical purposes.

Operational Role

Audit Retention Module governs the retention layer of audit preservation by ensuring that every audit artifact is retained for the appropriate duration according to established governance requirements and lifecycle obligations.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define Retention Requirements

Establish retention categories, retention periods, governance obligations, legal requirements, operational needs, responsible authorities, and review criteria.

2. Define Retention Methodology

Develop standardized procedures for assigning retention periods, managing lifecycle events, reviewing retention status, and maintaining governance compliance.

3. Define Retention Validation Logic

Verify that audit records are retained for the required period, remain accessible, satisfy governance requirements, and support future reconstruction and independent verification.

4. Define Governance Response

Establish procedures for premature deletion, expired retention periods, retention exceptions, governance conflicts, preservation failures, and corrective actions.

5. Preserve Retention Records

Maintain retention schedules, governance approvals, lifecycle reviews, validation history, timestamps, exceptions, and disposal authorizations throughout the audit lifecycle.

Example Use Cases

Use Case 1 — Autonomous AI Governance

Scenario

An organization determines how long audit records generated by autonomous AI systems must remain available for governance review.

Application

Audit Retention Module governs retention schedules, lifecycle management, review procedures, and governance approvals for all audit records.

Result

Audit information remains available for the required period while supporting future governance, investigations, and operational reconstruction.

Use Case 2 — Regulatory Compliance Audit

Scenario

A financial institution must retain audit records for legally mandated periods following external audits.

Application

Audit Retention Module governs retention duration, periodic review, governance compliance, and authorized disposal after retention obligations have been fulfilled.

Result

Audit records remain available throughout their required lifecycle while satisfying governance, legal, and regulatory obligations.

Canonical Closing Statement

Audit Retention Module establishes the canonical governance framework for retaining audit information throughout its required lifecycle. By governing retention methodology, lifecycle controls, governance requirements, validation, and continuous retention assurance, the module enables long-term audit trust, accountable governance, operational continuity, and independent verification across all operational domains.

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Canonical Source

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